A Product Requirements Document (PRD) is the **foundational strategic blueprint for any product initiative,** especially innovative ones. It articulates the crucial **why**, **what**, and **for whom** of the product, aligning diverse teams towards a common goal. A well-crafted PRD specifies product functionalities, features, and success criteria, ensuring the final product meets customer needs and drives business growth. For innovative products, it is particularly important to capture the dynamic, iterative nature of development, which can be challenging with traditional text-heavy documents. **Mind maps are presented as indispensable visual tools for injecting clarity, fostering shared understanding, visualizing complex relationships, and managing risks associated with innovation directly within the PRD framework.**

Here is a blueprint template for a PRD, drawing on the essential mind maps and information from the sources:

Product Requirements Document (PRD) Blueprint

I. Introduction

- **1.1 Purpose:** KisanSetu addresses agricultural credit information asymmetry by creating transparent, farmer-owned alternative credit profiles that answer who is trustworthy, how much credit is safe, what it should fund, repayment capacity, community risk reduction and data ownership.
- **1.2 Goals and Objectives:** Build MVP demonstrating conversion of verified agricultural data into explainable Farmer Trust Passport covering creditworthiness, safe credit limits, credit purpose, repayment capacity and agricultural risk while ensuring farmer data ownership and enabling consent-based sharing with legitimate lenders.
- **1.3 Scope:** Hackathon MVP covers FPO-verified production data integration, AGMARKNET and NHB benchmark analysis, transparent credit formula engine, IBM BOB explanation layer and farmer consent management for 500-farmer pilot demonstrating technical feasibility and commercial viability.
- **1.4 Target Audience (for the PRD):** Primary users are smallholder farmers and FPOs seeking transparent credit access; secondary users are rural banks, NBFCs and cooperatives requiring verified borrower assessment and reduced information costs.

II. Product Vision and Strategy

- **2.1 Product Vision:** Establish Farmer Trust Passport as the portable Agricultural Economic Identity standard enabling farmers to leverage verified production and community participation for transparent credit access while retaining complete data ownership and control.
- **2.2 Strategic Objectives:** Demonstrate explainable credit assessment methodology during hackathon, secure 3 bank partnerships for pilot validation, onboard 500 farmers through partner FPO and establish non-balance-sheet Lending Service Provider business model generating sustainable origination fees.
- **2.3 Core Value Proposition:** Farmers gain transparent understanding of creditworthiness with explainable formulas, control over data sharing and improved credit access; lenders receive verified borrower profiles reducing assessment costs; FPOs provide trusted verification reducing information asymmetry.
- **2.4 Key Differentiators:** Explainable credit components replace black-box scores, farmer-controlled consent replaces data extraction, FPO verification reduces lender risk, transparent formulas enable trust, IBM BOB provides vernacular explanations and non-balance-sheet model ensures regulatory compliance.

III. Target Audience and User Understanding

- **3.1.1 User Persona: Smallholder Farmer:**
  Goal: Obtain formal credit based on verified agricultural activity while understanding credit decisions and controlling data sharing with lenders.
  Journey: Register with FPO and provide production records for verification, Receive Farmer Trust Passport showing creditworthiness and safe credit limit with explanations, Grant consent to share specific data components with chosen bank and receive credit offer
- **3.1.2 User Persona: FPO Manager:**
  Goal: Verify member agricultural activity and transactions to reduce lending risk while generating revenue from platform services and improving member credit access.

Journey: Onboard member farmers and collect production and transaction records, Verify agricultural activity and input communitylevel signals into KisanSetu platform, Facilitate farmer consent management and earn service fees from transaction settlement

- **3.1.3 User Persona: Rural Bank Credit Officer:**
  Goal: Access verified borrower profiles with transparent risk assessment to reduce underwriting costs and improve agricultural lending portfolio quality.
  Journey: Receive farmer consent request for Trust Passport data access, Review explainable creditworthiness, safe credit limit, repayment capacity and agricultural risk components, Conduct final underwriting using verified data and approve credit with reduced assessment time
- **3.2 User Needs and Expectations:** Farmers need transparent credit decisions, data ownership and vernacular explanations; FPOs need verification tools and legitimate revenue; banks need verified borrower data, explainable risk assessment and reduced underwriting costs while maintaining regulatory compliance.
- **3.3 Context of Use:** Rural agricultural settings with limited digital literacy requiring vernacular voice interfaces, intermittent connectivity requiring offline capability and trust-based community relationships requiring FPO verification as credible information source.

IV. User Journey and Experience

- **4.1 Key User Scenarios:** Farmer registers via FPO providing production records, receives Trust Passport with explainable credit components via IBM BOB, grants selective consent to bank, bank reviews verified data and approves credit for productive agricultural purposes.
- **4.2 User Journey Maps:** Registration and FPO verification, Trust Passport generation with transparent formulas, IBM BOB explanation in vernacular language, consent management for selective data sharing, bank assessment using verified components and credit approval with recommended purpose allocation.
- **4.3 Pain Points and Opportunities:** Pain points include digital literacy barriers requiring voice interfaces, trust concerns requiring FPO verification and opaque decisions requiring explainable formulas; opportunities include farmer data ownership, reduced lender costs and improved credit access through transparency.

V. Product Features and Functionality

- **5.1 Feature Breakdown:** Farmer Trust Passport with six explainable components: Production Stability Score from FPO-verified records, Market Stability Score from AGMARKNET analysis, Repayment Capacity from expected crop revenue minus costs, Agricultural Risk Score from PMFBY and weather data, FPO Community Verification Score and Overall Creditworthiness; IBM BOB conversational explanation engine; farmer consent management dashboard; FPO verification portal; bank integration API.
- **5.2 Functional Requirements:** System must calculate Safe Credit Limit using formula: Acreage × NHB Benchmark Yield × Conservative AGMARKNET Price × Risk Haircut; compute Repayment Coverage as Expected Net Agricultural Income divided by Proposed Repayment; recommend credit purpose allocation based on crop, season and expected costs; generate tamper-evident audit trail of data access; support vernacular voice interaction via IBM BOB.
- **5.3 Non-Functional Requirements:** System must support offline data collection with sync capability, process 500 farmer profiles within 2 seconds, maintain 99.9% uptime during pilot, ensure role-based access control with farmer consent verification, provide audit trail for regulatory compliance and support Hindi, Tamil and Telugu languages initially.

VI. Market Analysis and Competitive Landscape

- **6.1 Market Opportunity:** India has 146 million agricultural households with 86% smallholders facing credit access barriers; formal agricultural credit gap exceeds $200 billion; FPOs covering 10 million farmers need member credit solutions; banks seek verified borrower data to reduce $15 billion agricultural NPA exposure.

- **6.2 Competitive Analysis:** Traditional credit bureaus lack agricultural data; fintech lenders use opaque scoring without farmer data ownership; government schemes provide subsidies but not credit profiles; KisanSetu differentiates through explainable formulas, farmer-controlled data, FPO verification and non-balance-sheet Lending Service Provider model.